

The Washington Post

Prices may vary in areas outside metropolitan Washington.

SU V1 V2 V3 V4



Partly sunny 86/68 • Tomorrow: Hazy, hot 94/72 **B6**

Democracy Dies in Darkness

WEDNESDAY, JUNE 11, 2025 • \$4

Big parade started out as Army's modest idea

With Trump in office, proposal from a year ago became supercharged

BY MATT VISER,
OLIVIA GEORGE
AND DAN LAMOTHE

On June 12, 2024, a day when Joe Biden was still president, running for reelection, and had every expectation of serving a second term, the U.S. Army filed a permit in the hopes of celebrating its 250th birthday on the National Mall the following year.

The event would involve as many as 300 soldiers and civilian personnel. There would be a concert by the U.S. Army Band. Four cannons would be fired. Some 120 chairs would be set up.

All told, it would be a fairly modest affair, another event on a summer's day on the national lawn, a few weeks before Fourth of July festivities would bring a much grander display.

Then President Donald Trump was elected — and plans for the day changed dramatically.

More than two dozen tanks will now roll through D.C., and 50 helicopters will fly overhead. Thousands of troops, many in period costume from past wars, will participate, and several musical acts will perform.

All told, it amounts to the grandest event since Trump took office for his second term, a spectacle that federal government and military officials have maneuvered to fulfill an ambitious and grandiose vision for celebrating the country and its military.

The large-scale military parade is the result of a confluence of interests: a president who has long pushed for the kind of grand pageant he'd witnessed in other

SEE PARADE ON A4

Gearing up for Saturday's celebrations



EVELYN HOCKSTEIN/REUTERS

President Donald Trump watches a military exercise Tuesday at Fort Bragg, North Carolina, where preparations are underway to mark the Army's 250th anniversary. Addressing the Los Angeles protests, he told soldiers, "This anarchy will not stand."

Ramp-up will see allies' citizens sent to Guantánamo

U.S. COULD MOVE THOUSANDS OF MIGRANTS

Britain, France, others unlikely to be notified of plans

BY JOHN HUDSON
AND ALEX HORTON

The Trump administration is preparing to begin the transfer of potentially thousands of foreigners who are in the United States illegally to the U.S. military base in Guantánamo Bay, Cuba, starting as early as this week, said U.S. officials familiar with the matter.

The foreign nationals under consideration hail from a range of countries. They include hundreds from friendly European nations, including Britain, Italy, France, Germany, Ireland, Belgium, the Netherlands, Lithuania, Poland, Turkey and Ukraine, but also other parts of the world,

including many from Haiti. Officials shared the plans with The Washington Post, including some documents, on the condition of anonymity because the matter is considered highly sensitive.

The administration is unlikely to inform the foreigners' home governments about the impending transfers to the infamous military facility, including close U.S. allies such as Britain, Germany and France, the officials said.

The preparations include medical screening for 9,000 individuals to determine whether they are healthy enough to be

SEE GUANTÁNAMO ON A2

Trump: Show of force is a warning to other cities

BY MATT VISER,
TIM CRAIG,
REIS THEBAULT
AND DAN LAMOTHE

FORT BRAGG, N.C. — President Donald Trump warned Tuesday that additional protests against federal immigration policies could be "met with equal or greater force" than the 4,000 National Guard members and 700 Marines he deployed to try to quell demonstrations in Los Angeles.

Trump, speaking to soldiers here, said California's largest city needs to be liberated, defending his decision to send thousands of service members to suppress what he called "paid troublemakers"

and agents of a "foreign invasion."

"This anarchy will not stand," Trump said, referring to protests.

U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement raids that sparked days of protests in Los Angeles continued Tuesday, resulting in more than 100 arrests. The demonstrations also spread to additional cities, including Austin, San Francisco, Portland, Oregon and Seattle.

Most of the demonstrations

SEE PROTEST ON A7

Rapid removals: Attorneys and families find some already gone. **A5**

Viral images: Protests are a social media spectacle for both sides. **A6**

Spain weighs criminal charges in deadly floods

Mishandling of disaster that killed 228 may lead to rare prosecutions

BY CHICO HARLAN,
MICHAEL ROBINSON CHÁVEZ
AND ROSER TOLL PIFARRÉ

VALENCIA, SPAIN — The floodwaters charged downhill on Oct. 29, roaring through ravines, churning with debris, and then deluging neighborhoods that had been given no warning.

At 6 p.m., a family caught in the raging waters tried clinging to iron window bars outside their home; by 6:30, only one person — 70-year-old Dolores Ruiz — was still hanging on.

At 6:53 p.m., a pregnant 26-year-old coming home from work called her mother to say that water was entering the car and that she'd try to escape to the roof.

At 7:57 p.m., a drowning widower spoke with his daughter, who urged him to move to higher ground but heard him say just before the call cut off, "I can't, sweetheart, I can't."

And then, at 8:11 p.m., smartphones across the region buzzed with the first emergency alert from the regional government, warning of the risk from heavy rains. By then, much of Valencia was already underwater.

In the immediate aftermath of

the floods that killed at least 228, Valencians knew that the official response had gone terribly wrong. Now, Spain is asking whether the mismanagement was not just catastrophic but criminal.

Over the past few months, a judge has been interviewing survivors and collecting phone records and text messages while summoning insiders to testify about what happened behind the scenes. Already, Judge Nuria Ruiz Tobarra — whose own courthouse was flooded — has placed two politicians involved with the emergency response under investigation and is weighing whether to indict them on charges of reckless homicide and reckless injury. The premise of the investigation is stark: that many of the deaths were preventable.

"A failure," the judge wrote in court documents about the delayed alert. The deaths and devastation "all occurred amid the clear inaction of the regional administration."

In exploring criminal charges, Spain is now testing how far a democracy can go in holding officials accountable after an extreme natural disaster. Experts caution that it is difficult — and exceedingly rare — to prosecute decision-makers for their actions in frantic moments. Even after Hurricane Katrina in the United States in 2005 — which was marked by delayed evacuations

SEE FLOOD ON A10



ILLUSTRATION BY SALLY DENG/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

ON THE BOX

D.C. court officials repeatedly lost track of teens wearing ankle monitors. The timing was deadly.

BY AMY BRITTAIN

The boys were in trouble. Maurice Jackson Jr., 15, and Mylaki Young, 16, had both missed too much school and were suspected of committing crimes. By late 2022, they were living with five other teens in a vacant apartment in Southeast Washington. The place was strewn with ghost gun parts and bullets.

After police raided the apartment, both boys were arrested. In D.C. Superior Court, Mylaki was charged with being a habitual runaway, while Maurice was already facing criminal charges from a prior arrest. The teens were outfitted with GPS ankle monitors to track them

while they were free in the community, awaiting the resolution of their court cases.

"Youth installed on device 22-028488," noted Mylaki's court record on Dec. 9, 2022, when Judge Sherri Beatty-Arthur ordered him released. "... Charger and instructions were provided."

It was Mylaki's first time on "the box," as many teens called it. But for Maurice, the box was nothing new. He had worn one just a few weeks earlier.

The monitors were supposed to help authorities keep watch over them.

But a Washington Post investigation reveals

SEE MONITORS ON A12

Glowing axolotls shed light on limb regeneration

BY DINO GRANDONI

With a silly smile and frilly gills, the axolotl has wriggled its way into the hearts of millions, becoming a popular aquarium pet and pop culture icon in video games, children's books and toy stores.

But this adorable species of salamander is also helping researchers investigate a serious medical mystery: Could the human body be coaxed to regrow a severed arm or leg?

Scientists are turning to the axolotl because it is an expert at regeneration. After losing a limb, an adult axolotl can grow it back fresh and new.

In a study published in the journal Nature Communications on Tuesday, scientists used axolotls genetically engineered to glow in the dark to understand the molecular underpinnings of this amazing trait.

"This species is special," said James Monaghan, a Northeastern

SEE AXOLOTLS ON A11



ALYSSA STONE/NORTHEASTERN UNIVERSITY

IN THE NEWS

Sanctions against Israel Five Western nations announced measures targeting two far-right ministers who they say have incited violence in the West Bank. **A9**

A salty crisis An overapplication of thawing agents for winter ice is increasing the salinity in the D.C. region's freshwater ecosystems. **B1**

THE NATION Democrats repeatedly clashed with Pete Hegseth during a hearing. **A3** The president can abolish national monuments designated by his predecessors, the Justice Department concluded. **A3**

THE WORLD A Russian air assault sparked fires in Kyiv and hit a maternity hospital in Odessa. **A8** A shooting at a high school in Graz, Austria, left at least 10 victims dead. **A11**

THE ECONOMY China resumed trade talks with the United States holding, in its view, a strong hand, and resulting in a late-night "handshake" deal. **A16** The World Bank effectively endorsed President Donald Trump's gripe over other nations' tariffs on U.S. goods. **A16**

THE REGION The House voted to repeal D.C. laws that allow some noncitizen voting and bar the city police union from bargaining on officer discipline. **B1** Virginia Senate Democrats rejected eight of Gov. Glenn Youngkin's appointees to public university boards. **B1**

STYLE The Smithsonian's board publicly backed the institution's secretary after Trump attempted to oust a museum director. **C1**

FOOD A writer who loves cooking for her dad whips up a cake that's all about him. **E1**

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OPINION PAGES.....A17
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